

My Regulation Toolkit

SCRIPTS FOR THE HARD MOMENTS

Most ADHD girls, like most of us, tend to need to feel seen before anything else can land. Before a tool, before a redirection, before a solution. Just seen.

Psychiatrist Dr. Dan Siegel talks about "name it to tame it", the idea that when we put simple words to what someone is feeling, it may help the brain begin to settle. It's a gentle, research-informed idea worth exploring.

Brainstorm: The Power and Purpose of the Teenage Brain by Dr. Dan Siegel

These scripts are loosely guided by that idea. You'll notice they tend to start with presence and acknowledgement rather than fixing. Some parents and carers find that helpful. Some find their own words work better. Both are completely fine.

Parenting or caring for a girl with ADHD in the hard moments is genuinely hard. These are not instructions. They're just some suggestions for when you're lost for words, a starting point if you need one. Take what feels right. Leave what doesn't.

The After-School Collapse

She's been holding it together all day. Home is where it comes out.

WHEN YOU SEE IT COMING

"You're home. You don't have to talk yet."

WHEN SHE'S IN IT

"I can see today was a lot. I'm right here. No rush."

AFTER, WHEN THINGS HAVE SETTLED

"How are you feeling now? We don't need to talk about what happened if you're not ready."

Big Emotions and Meltdowns

Something shifted. The reaction feels bigger than the moment.

WHEN YOU SEE IT BUILDING

"I can see something shifted. Do you want space or do you want me close?"

WHEN SHE'S IN IT

"I'm here. You don't have to explain anything. I'm not going anywhere."

AFTER, WHEN SHE'S CALMER

"That was a big wave. You're not in trouble. We can figure it out together when you're ready."

Starting Homework

The work hasn't started yet. The resistance already has.

WHEN YOU SEE IT BUILDING

"Let's get your body settled before we look at the work."

WHEN SHE'S IN IT

"This feels really hard right now. What's the one smallest thing we could start with?"

AFTER, WHEN THINGS HAVE SETTLED

"You got through it. Even when it felt like you couldn't."

The Chaotic Morning

The body isn't ready. The clock doesn't care.

WHEN YOU SEE IT BUILDING

"I can see your body is struggling to get going. Let's just do one thing at a time."

WHEN SHE'S IN IT

"We've got a bit of time. What's feeling the hardest right now?"

AFTER, AT DROP OFF OR IN THE CAR

"That was a tough one. I hope the rest of your day feels easier."

Regulation in the Classroom

You're not there. But you can help her prepare.

BEFORE SCHOOL

"If your body starts to feel buzzy or heavy in class, remember you can STOP. Even for ten seconds. Nobody can see you doing it."

SOMETHING SHE CAN SAY TO HERSELF OR A TRUSTED TEACHER

"I need a moment. Can I go to the bathroom?"

AFTER SCHOOL, WHEN SHE TELLS YOU ABOUT A HARD MOMENT

"It sounds like your nervous system was working really hard in there. That takes a lot. I'm glad you noticed."

Sleep Readiness

The brain is still going. The body needs to slow down.

WHEN STARTING THE WIND-DOWN

"I know your brain is still busy. We're just going to slow things down a bit. No pressure to sleep yet."

WHEN SHE CAN'T SETTLE

"You don't have to figure anything out tonight. Whatever's on your mind can wait until morning."

WHEN SHE NEEDS COMPANY

"Do you want me to stay here with you for a bit?"

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